



Lenovo buying Motorola

Google has decided to sell Motorola's handset division to Lenovo for \$2.91 billion
<http://dgit.in/LenoMoto>



Speedy Sandisk

Sandisk's new USB 3.0 pen drives provide write speeds up to 240MB/sec
<http://dgit.in/MiuMB9>

parts of the car will be available to owners for the next 8-10 years.

Talk to your feet through your shoes

Ducere Technologies – founded by Indian techies, Krispian Lawrence and Anirudh Sharma –



LECHAL – The Shoe

has announced the launch of LeChal (pronounced lay-ch-al, meaning “take me there” in Hindi). It claims to be the world's first interactive footwear with haptic feedback. The product is the first of many fashion segments that the company hopes to tap into. At the same time the product has its roots in a socially beneficial noble cause. Lechal was started as a project with a social aspect, which was to create an walking aid for the visually impaired. Each pair sold would result in a subsidised pair for blind people.

In the press conference held at Mumbai, CEO Krispian Lawrence unveiled two products, the first being an insole which can be slipped into any footwear to make it interactive and a shoe with the same technology incorporated in it. Let's look at the details of the two products.

Insole

Launching on March 7, 2014, the insole has all the electronics located at the heel. All of these electronic components have been fitted into a small module which can be easily

removed. Each module has a weight threshold of 500 kg. The remaining portion of the insole can be replaced as and when they get worn out. The company hopes to keep the price of the insole below \$100 (₹6,213) while the replaceable portion can be obtained for ₹500, however, the

final price would be unveiled on the launch date.

Shoe

The shoe has a flap near the rear cuff where the battery is slid in. The haptic feedback module might be located in the heel of the shoe. The shoe will be launched in the colours, red and black. The pricing of the shoes wasn't disclosed.

Charger

Each module comes with a rechargeable battery that has reversible contacts. The charger has an in-built clapper which when activated beeps in a certain pattern to indicate the level of charge.

App

The shoes work by communicating with the user's smartphone via Bluetooth. The phone must have a dedicated Android, iOS or Windows navigation app installed. While the user can interact via voice commands, to simplify things, most of the operations can be performed using the volume keys on your smartphone. The release date

for the app hasn't been revealed.

Development time

The prototype first made the headlines back in mid 2011 when the primary focus was towards developing an aid for the visually disabled. The prototype was developed on Arduino but the company later migrated to AVR. When asked whether the API for the app would be released, Krispian responded saying that they would release the API after further development, but there would be restrictions placed on the developers.

Future use

The prototype models are being tested out at the L.V. Prasad Eye Institute, Hyderabad where inputs from the visually impaired are being used towards further development. Ducere will start taking preorders on March 7.

Can Google Glass end Cancer?

Google Glass was used by surgeons in a cancer surgery to summon patient records. Two

out the patient's records, including MRI and X-ray information on its display for the surgeons' reference, just out of the surgeons line of sight during the surgery.

The doctors have big plans for Google Glass and want to use the wearable technology to stream videos for educational purpose, giving students insights into different stages of surgery. Dr. Szotek also plans to use biological tracers that could help Google Glass tell apart tumours from healthy tissue.

Doctors suggest that this automatic differentiation “could revolutionise the field of cancer surgery” and will help in complete removal of cancerous tissue while still leaving as much healthy tissue behind as possible.

Google Glass is not the only wearable technology making inroads in the medical field. Researchers at Washington University recently demonstrated their own smart glasses system that was capable of identifying cancerous tissue.



Google Glass – the modern know-it-all nurse

physicians, Dr. Szotek and Dr. Jeff Browne, each sported Google Glass during a four-hour abdominal surgery and relied on Google's voice control to access medical information as they sliced out a tumour. Google Glass was able to pull

This eyewear could help surgeons remove tumours from patients with breast cancer or melanoma. The eyewear shows the wearer margins of tumours more accurately when a dye is used to fluoresce a tumour's borders.